

WatchSchedule Scheduling Rules

WatchSchedule generates schedules using a configurable rules engine designed specifically for superyacht watchkeeping operations.

Fairness Rules

Equal Duty Distribution

The system aims to distribute duties as evenly as possible across all eligible watchkeepers.

Leave-Neutral Scheduling

Crew members are not penalised for taking approved leave.

The system does not automatically assign additional duties simply because a crew member has been unavailable.

Historical Fairness

Duty allocation considers previous assignments to help maintain fairness over time rather than only within the current schedule.

Consecutive Duty Rules

Consecutive Duties Disabled (Default)

A watchkeeper cannot be assigned consecutive duties.

Example:

✓ Monday ✗ Tuesday

Consecutive Weekend Duties Allowed

If enabled, a watchkeeper may be assigned consecutive weekend duties.

Example:

✓ Saturday ✓ Sunday

This setting is configurable.

Extended Weekend Duty Mode

If enabled, the system may allocate:

✓ Friday ✓ Saturday ✓ Sunday

to the same watchkeeper.

This is useful for vessels operating weekend duty blocks rather than individual duty days.

Weekend Fairness Rules

Weekend Distribution

Weekend duties are distributed as evenly as possible across all eligible watchkeepers.

Weekend Protection

Where practical, a crew member assigned weekend duty will not also be assigned adjacent Friday or Monday duties.

Example:

✗ Friday + Saturday ✗ Sunday + Monday

unless specifically permitted by vessel settings.

Weekend Block Mode

If enabled, weekend duties may be grouped into a single duty block.

Example:

Friday → Sunday

The system then compensates through future scheduling to maintain fairness.

Charter Rules

Charter Pause

Normal duty sequencing may be paused during charter periods.

Charter Resume

Following charter completion, the schedule resumes from the correct position without disrupting fairness or continuity.

Availability Rules

Leave

Crew on leave are automatically excluded from scheduling.

Joiners

New crew members can be introduced into the schedule at a configurable starting point.

Leavers

Departing crew are removed without affecting the integrity of the remaining schedule.

Relief Crew

Relief personnel can temporarily assume duties without permanently affecting fairness calculations.

Rotation Continuity Rules

Continuity Preservation

The system attempts to maintain the established scheduling sequence despite:

- Leave periods
- Charter interruptions
- Crew changes
- Relief crew

Sequence Recovery

Where disruption occurs, WatchSchedule identifies the most appropriate point to resume scheduling while maintaining fairness and continuity.

Publication Rules

Schedules can only be published once all mandatory rules have been satisfied or overridden by an authorised user.

Any rule overrides are recorded within the schedule history.